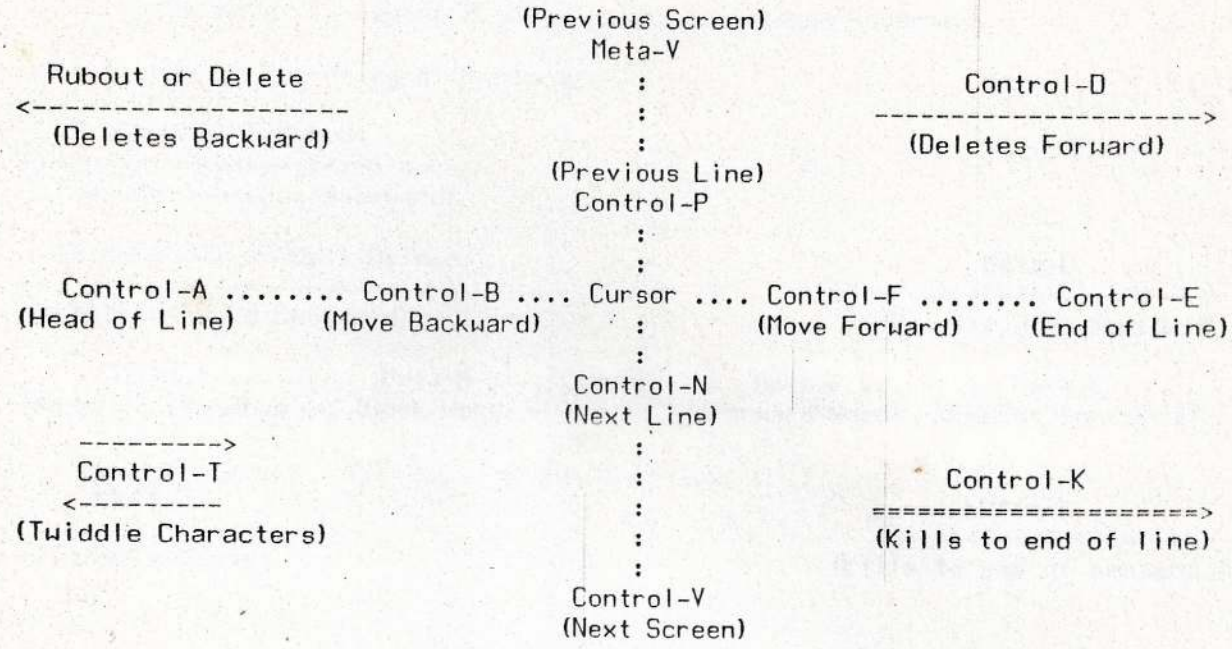
Meta-< goes to beginning of buffer.



Meta-> goes to end of buffer.

Emacs commands try to be very regular. There are Meta- commands similar to these Control- commands which work on words in much the same way as these commands work on characters. Control-Meta- commands work in similar ways on Lisp S-Expressions. Watch for and make use of these trends. They can really reduce the number of things you have to remember.

---------- Useful Sub-Topics ----------

*** HELP ***

[Help] Top-H on a TV keyboard or Control-Underscore H (^_H) on a normal ASCII keyboard will offer help almost anywhere at any time in Emacs. Documentation comes in many flavors -- this document should serve as a guide to give you an idea about what you've been overlooking in other documentation.

Meta-? (On an ascii keyboard, Altmode-?) will read another character and describe its action. You should use Meta-? to describe any commands you read about in this document which you would like to understand in full detail. The info given here is intended only as an index and is not complete.

*** QUIT ***

Control-G aborts all currently executing operations, flushes typeahead, and leaves you at the innermost invocation of ^R-mode.

Control-] aborts a recursive ^R-mode (such as RMail Reply -- exits without sending any mail).

Useful META- Commands
(On an ascii keyboard, Meta-<char> is Altmode <char>)

Meta-[goes to Beginning of Paragraph

Control-X Rubout
<==========
(Delete Sentence Backward)

Meta-Rubout or Meta-Delete
<----------
(Deletes Word Backward)

Meta-D
---------->
(Deletes Word Forward)

Meta-A ..... Meta-B .... Cursor .... Meta-F ..... Meta-E
(Head of Sentence) (Back Word) (Forward Word) (End of Sentence)

---------->
Meta-T
<---------
(Twiddle Words)

Meta-K
==========>
(Kills to end of sentence)

Meta-] goes to End of Paragraph

Useful CONTROL-META- Commands
(On an ascii keyboard, C-M-<char> is Control-C <char>)

C-M-[goes to Beginning of Defun

C-M-Rubout or C-M-Delete
<----------
(Deletes S-Expression Backward)

C-M-D or C-M-K
---------->
(Deletes S-Expression Forward)

(Backward Up List)
C-M-U
:
(Backward List)
C-M-P
:
C-M-A ..... C-M-B ..... Cursor ..... C-M-F ..... C-M-E
(Beginning of S-Exp) (Back S-Exp) : (Forward S-Exp) (End of S-Exp)
C-M-N
(Forward List)
:
C-M-D
(Forward Down List)

---------->
Control-T
<---------
(Twiddle S-Expressions)

C-M-] goes to End of Defun

*** EXTENDED COMMANDS ***

Meta-X runs the extended command set completing reader (MM Commands).

*** SPECIAL PREFIX CHARACTERS ***

Control-X (Dispatch Character)
reads exactly one more character. What that character is will decide what macro is run. These commands, called the 'Control-X commands' can be documented by typing Control-X ?

Control-U (Argument Prefix)
is the 'Universal' argument prefix.

Control-U digit digit ... digit non-digit-command

will accumulate the digits as a numerical argument to the next command. For example,

Control-U 1 2 3 Control-B

moves backward 123 characters. If not followed by digits, Control-U will multiply the arg to the next command by 4. eg,

Control-U Control-B

will move backward 4 characters - note that

Control-U Control-U Control-B

will move backward 16 characters.

*** PREFIX CHARACTERS FOR ASCII TERMINALS (Non-TV's) ***

Control-^ - Prefix Control
Control-C - Prefix Control-Meta
Altmode - Prefix Meta
Control-\ - Prefix Meta

These commands read the next character and adjust it appropriately. For example, Control-C C is equivalent to Control-Meta-C and Altmode C is equivalent to Meta-C.

*** QUOTE ***

Control-Q is the EMACS quote character. The next character typed after it will be inserted literally into the buffer rather than having its normal effect.

Disclaimer: This documentation lies about one thing. There is a difference between Control-H and Backspace, Control-I and Tab, Control-J and Linefeed, etc. but most of these pairs of keys do identical things and the distinction would not be interesting to most people, so for simplicity they are treated as synonymous here when in fact they are not. Sophisticated users should see other documentation for more details.

Cursor Control

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
H	Backspace or Control-H	Backward Character
A	Control-A	Beginning of Line
	Meta-A	Beginning of Sentence
	Control-Meta-A	Beginning of Defun
B	Control-B	Backward Character
	Meta-B	Backward Word
	Control-Meta-B	Backward S-Expression
D	Control-Meta-D	Down List
E	Control-E	End of Line
	Meta-E	End of Sentence
	Control-Meta-E	End of Defun
F	Control-F	Forward Character
	Meta-F	Forward Word
	Control-Meta-F	Foward S-Expression
M	Meta-M	Move to beginning of text on current line
	Control-Meta-M	Move to beginning of text on current line
[	Meta-[	Move to beginning of paragraph
	Control-Meta-[	Move to beginning of defun
	Control-X [	Move to beginning of page
]	Meta-]	Move to beginning of paragraph
	Control-Meta-]	Move to beginning of DEFUN
	Control-X]	Move to beginning of page

CURSOR CONTROL (cont'd)

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
N	Control-N	Move to Next Line
	Meta-N	Move to Next Comment Line
	Control-Meta-N	Move across Next List
P	Control-P	Move to Previous Line
	Meta-P	Move to Previous Comment Line
	Control-Meta-P	Move across Previous List
U	Control-Meta-U	Up List
V	Control-V	View Next Page
	Meta-V	View Previous Page
X	Control-X ^X	Exchange point (cursor position) and mark

DISPLAY

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
L	Form or Control-L	Clears screen and redisplays
R	Meta-R	Move cursor relative to screen position
	Control-Meta-R	Reposition window

SEARCHING

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
R	Control-R	Reverse Search
S	Control-S	Search (forward)

MOVING TEXT

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
	Control-T	Twiddle Characters
T	Meta-T	Twiddle Words
	Control-Meta-T	Twiddle S-Expressions
	Control-X ^T	Twiddle Lines

PREFIX CHARACTERS

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
Altmode	Altmode	Meta-Prefix Character (doesn't do this in a mini-buffer)
\	Control-\	Meta-Prefix Character (good for use in mini-buffer)
C	Control-C	Control-Meta Prefix Character
Q	Control-Q	Quote Prefix (Inserts next character typed)
U	Control-U	'Universal' Argument Prefix
X	Control-X	Control-X Command Prefix

READING AND WRITING FILES

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
E	Control-X ^E	Edit File
F	Control-X ^F	Find File
Q	Control-X ^Q	Inhibit Auto-Writeback (see ^X^E documentation)
R	Control-X ^R	Read File
S	Control-X ^S	Save File (under default filename)
V	Control-X ^V	Visit File
W	Control-X ^W	Write File (reads a filename)

BUFFER MANIPULATION

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
A	Control-X A	Append to Buffer
B	Control-X B	Select Buffer
	Control-X ^B	List Buffers
K	Control-X K	Kill Buffer

INDENTATION

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
	Tab or Control-I	Indent According to Mode
I	Meta-I	Indent to Tab Stop
	Control-Meta-I	Indent for Lisp
	^X Tab	Indent Rigidly
J	Linefeed or Control-J	Indent New Line
K	Control-Meta-Q	Indent All Lines in Next S-Expression
;	Meta-;	Indent for Comment

BLANK LINES AND CARRIAGE RETURNS

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
M	Control-M	Insert a Carriage-Return (TV's only)
	Return	Insert a Carriage-Return + Linefeed (CRLF)
O	Control-O	Open a Blank Line (insert a CRLF after cursor)
	Control-Meta-O	Open a Blank Line; move text vertically down
	Control-X ^O	Kill Blank Lines around this line's end

MARKING A REGION

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
H	Meta-H	Mark Paragraph
	Control-Meta-H	Mark S-Expression
	Control-X H	Mark Whole Buffer
P	Control-X ^P	Mark Page

TEXT DELETION

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
Rubout or Delete	Rubout	Delete character backward
	Meta-Rubout	Delete word backward
	Control-Meta-Rubout	Delete s-expression backward
	Control-X Rubout	Delete sentence backward
D	Control-D	Delete character forward
	Meta-D	Delete word forward
K	Control-K	Kill Line Forward
	Meta-K	Kill Sentence Forward
	Control-Meta-K	Kill S-Expression Forward
W	Control-W	Kill Region
;	Control-Meta-;	Kill Comment

TEXT COPYING

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
A	Control-X A	Append Region to a Specified Buffer
W	Meta-W	Copy Region
	Control-Meta-W	Make next kill join previous in kill buffer

RESTORING DELETED/COPIED TEXT

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
Y	Control-Y	Yank last item from kill buffer into buffer.
	Meta-Y	Yank 'the kill before that' (only after ^Y)
	Control-Meta-Y	Mini-buffer only: Yank last mini-buffer command string. RMAIL Reply only: Yank text of message. (Not defined anywhere else)

COMMENT FIELDS

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
J	Meta-J	Indent New Comment Line
	Control-Meta-J	Indent New Comment Line
N	Meta-N	Move to Next Comment Line
P	Meta-P	Move to Previous Comment Line
;	Meta-;	Indent for Comment
	Control-Meta-;	Kill Comment

Control-X ;

SUBSYSTEMS

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
D	Control-X D	DIRED (a Directory Editor)
I	Control-X I	INFO (like :INFO at DDT)
M	Control-X M	MAIL (send MAIL to other users)
R	Control-X R	RMAIL (like :RMAIL at DDT)

TECO RELATED COMMANDS

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
G	Control-X G	Get from Q-Register
X	Control-X X	Put in Q-Register

EXTENDED COMMANDS

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
X	Meta-X	Run MM Command in echo area
	Control-Meta-X	Run MM Command in minibuffer

QUIT/EXIT COMMANDS

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
C	Control-Meta-C	Exit ^R Mode
	Control-X ^C	Exit Job Temporarily - Return to Superior
G	Control-G	Abort currently executing command
]	Control-]	Abort a recursive ^R-mode (eg, flush RMAIL Reply without sending mail)
Z	Control-Z	Exit Job Temporarily - Return to superior

SETTING COLUMN VARIABLES

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
F	Control-X F	Set Fill Column
N	Control-X ^N	Set goal column (for ^N and ^P commands)

DIRECTORY HACKING COMMANDS

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
D	Control-X D	DIRED (a Directory Editor)
	Control-X ^D	Directory Listing (of files related to buffer)

CASIFYING

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
C	Meta-C	Capitalize Word
L	Meta-L	Lowercasify word
	Control-X ^L	Lowercasify Region
U	Meta-U	Uppercasify word
	Control-X ^U	Uppercasify region

FORMATTING TEXT

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
G	Meta-G	Fill Text Region
	Control-Meta-G	Grind Lisp or Macsyma code
Q	Meta-Q	Fill paragraph
S	Meta-S	Center text on line

INFORMATION ABOUT BUFFERED TEXT

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
L	Control-X L	Count Lines on Current Page
=	Control-X =	Info about Screen and Buffer Position

COMMANDS FOR DEALING WITH 2 WINDOWS

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
1	Control-X 1	Return to 1-window mode
2	Control-X 2	Enter 2-window mode (use other window)
3	Control-X 3	Enter 2-window mode (use same window)
4	Control-X 4	Enter 2-window mode with fancy options
O	Control-X O	Move to Other Window
V	Control-Meta-V	View Next Page of other window
^	Control-X ^	Grow Window

CHANGING VIRTUAL BUFFER BOUNDARIES

Character	Control-Bits	Meaning
N	Control-X N	Narrow Buffer Bounds (to size of region)
P	Control-X P	Narrow Buffer Bounds (to current page)
W	Control-X W	Widen buffer boundaries (to whole buffer)